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Variable lordosis endplate

Abstract

A variable lordosis endplate that may adjusted from 0 to 30 degrees using a mechanical drive that allows the spine's angle to be physically adjusted in-situ. The variable lordosis endplate may be quickly attached to either end, or both ends, of the central column. The variable lordosis endplate can be attached in orientations of every 15 degrees. The variable lordosis endplates' lordotic angles may be on either end of the column independently from one another. By attaching a variable lordosis endplate to both ends of the column, hyper-lordotic angles may be achieved.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/414,814 filed Oct. 10, 2022, which is incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

(1) The present invention relates generally to the field of spinal surgery, and more specifically, to a vertebral body replacement having a variable lordosis endplate.

BACKGROUND

(2) A spinal disc can become damaged as a result of degeneration, dysfunction, disease and/or trauma. Conservative treatment can include non-operative treatment through exercise and/or pain relievers to deal with the pain. In surgical treatments, interbody spacers may be used between adjacent vertebra, resulting in spinal fusion of the adjacent vertebra. Treatment options include disc removal and replacement using an interbody spacer, such as anterior cervical interbody fusion (ACIF), anterior lumbar interbody fusion (ALIF), direct lateral interbody fusion (DLIF) (also known as XLIF), posterior lumbar interbody fusion (PLIF), and transforaminal lumbar interbody fusion (TLIF).

(3) The current standard of care for interbody fusion requires surgical removal of all or a portion of the intervertebral disc. After removal of the intervertebral disc, the interbody spacer is inserted into the intervertebral space to occupy the intervertebral space after the disc is removed. This requires that an opening sufficient to allow the interbody spacer must be created through surrounding tissue to permit the interbody spacer to be inserted into the intervertebral space.

(4) In some cases, the interbody spacer may be required to change or correct the lordosis angle of the intervertebral space. Current systems offer a large selection of implants of varying lordosis and footprint options to meet specific patient anatomy requirements. This large selection of implants dramatically increases the amount of required inventory required by the implant manufacturer.

(5) It would be desirable to have a variable lordosis implant that can have its lordosis dynamically adjusted to meet any patient's lordosis requirement.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(6) Embodiments of the present invention are directed to a variable lordosis endplate that may be quickly attached to either end (or both ends) of the central column. The variable lordosis endplate

can be attached in orientations of every 15 degrees. The variable lordosis endplates' lordotic angles may be adjusted in-situ from 0 to 30 degrees on either end of the column independently from one another. The variable lordosis endplate has a drive mechanism, such as a mechanical drive, that allows the spine's angle to be physically adjusted. By attaching a variable lordosis endplate to both ends of the column, hyper-lordotic angles may be achieved. One or both of the variable lordosis endplates may be removed from the central column if desired.

(7) Further embodiments, features, objects and advantages of the invention, as well as structure and operation of various embodiments of the invention, are disclosed in detail below with references to the accompanying drawings. There has thus been outlined, rather broadly, the more important features of the invention in order that the detailed description thereof may be better understood, and in order that the present contribution to the art may be better appreciated. There are additional features of the invention that will be described hereinafter and which will form the subject matter of the claims appended hereto. The features listed herein and other features, aspects and advantages of the present invention will become better understood with reference to the following description and appended claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The present embodiments may be understood from the following detailed description when read in conjunction with the accompanying figures. It is emphasized that the various features of the figures are not necessarily to scale. On the contrary, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily expanded or reduced for clarity.

(2) FIGS. 1A, 1B are a perspective view and a side view showing one embodiment of variable lordosis endplate in a collapsed state.

(3) FIGS. 2A, 2B are a perspective view and a side view showing the variable lordosis endplate in an expanded state.

(4) FIGS. 3A, 3B show a front view and a sectional view of the variable lordosis endplate in the collapsed state.

(5) FIGS. 4A, 4B show a front view and a sectional view of the variable lordosis endplate in the expanded state.

(6) FIG. 5 is an exploded perspective view showing of the variable lordosis endplate.

(7) FIGS. 6A-6C show an embodiment of a cervical variable lordosis endplate showing a front view and a perspective view of the variable lordosis endplate in a collapsed state and a perspective view showing the variable lordosis endplate in an expanded state.

(8) FIGS. 7A-7C show an embodiment of a thoracic variable lordosis endplate showing a front view and a perspective view of the variable lordosis endplate in a collapsed state and a perspective view showing the variable lordosis endplate in an expanded state. The thoracic variable lordosis endplate includes an upper endplate that is round and larger than the cervical upper endplate.

(9) FIGS. 8A-8C show an embodiment of a lumbar variable lordosis endplate showing a front view and a perspective view of the variable lordosis endplate in a collapsed state and a perspective view showing the variable lordosis endplate in an expanded state. The lumbar variable lordosis endplate shown includes an upper endplate that is rectangular and larger than the cervical or thoracic endplate.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Embodiments of the invention will now be described with reference to the figures, wherein like numerals reflect like elements throughout. The terminology used in the description presented herein is not intended to be interpreted in any limited or restrictive way, simply because it is being utilized in conjunction with detailed description of certain specific embodiments of the invention.

Furthermore, embodiments of the invention may include several novel features, no single one of which is solely responsible for its desirable attributes or which is essential to practicing the invention described herein.

(11) Broadly, the present invention provides a variable lordosis endplate that may be quickly attached to either end (or both ends) of the central corpectomy column. The variable lordosis endplate can be attached in orientations of every 15 degrees. The variable lordosis endplates' lordotic angles may be adjusted in-situ from 0 to 30 degrees on either end of the column independently from one another. The variable lordosis endplate has mechanical drive that allows the spine's angle to be physically adjusted. By attaching a variable lordosis endplate to both ends of the column, hyper-lordotic angles may be achieved. One or both of the variable lordosis endplates may be removed from the central column if desired. The variable lordosis endplate described herein may be cervical, thoracic or lumbar variable lordosis plates.

(12) The present invention provides a variable lordosis endplate that utilizes a novel mechanical lordosis adjustment mechanism that includes a drive mechanism to translate a shuttle perpendicular to the longitudinal axis of the central column. The endplate only rotates about a posterior hinge pin and relies on the adjustment mechanism for height adjustment. The posterior hinge pin is offset from the column's central, longitudinal axis. Anterior shuttle pins are in double mechanical shear while the posterior hinge pin is in quadruple mechanical shear, increasing the strength of the mechanism and causing the shuttle to assume an abstract profile. As the shuttle translates, it encapsulates the portion of the body that houses the driver. This increases the torsional strength of the assembly. The invention features quick-connect modularity to either end of the central column.

(13) FIGS. 1A, 1B show a perspective view and a side view of one embodiment of variable lordosis endplate **100** in a collapsed state. A preassembled lordosis endplate **100** is designed to be quickly attached to either end, or both ends, of a central column. The variable lordosis endplate **100** can be attached in orientations of every 15 degrees. Attaching the variable lordosis endplate **100** to both ends of the column, hyper-lordotic angles may be achieved. One or both of the endplates may be removed from the central column if desired. The variable lordosis endplate **100** has mechanical drive **106** that allows the spine's angle to be physically adjusted.

(14) The variable lordosis endplate **100** includes a lower endplate or body **102** rotatably coupled to an upper endplate **114** with a hinge pin **116**. A driver **106** is rotationally coupled to the body **102**. A shuttle **110** is coupled to the driver **106** and slidingly coupled to the upper endplate **114** with a shuttle pin **112**.

(15) FIGS. 2A, 2B show a perspective view and a side view of the variable lordosis endplate **100** in an expanded state. Rotation of the driver **106** is configured to move the shuttle proximally or distally **T1** to lift or lower the proximal portion of the upper endplate **114** away from the lower endplate **102** to change the lordotic angle. The lordotic angle of the upper endplate **114** may be adjusted from 0 to 30 degrees, either before implantation or in-situ by the surgeon. The lordotic angle of the upper endplate **114** may be any angle between the collapsed state, 0 degrees, and the expanded state, 30 degrees.

(16) To expand the variable lordosis endplate **100** from the collapsed state to expanded state, the driver **106** is rotated **R1** so that the shuttle **110** translates **T1** proximally along a threaded portion of the driver **106**. As the shuttle **106** translates, the shuttle pins **112** translate **T2** or slide in angled slots **152**, rotating **R2** the upper endplate **114** on the hinge pin **116**. The rotation on the hinge pin **116** raises the proximal end of the upper endplate **114** away from the proximal end of the body **102**, thereby changing the lordotic angle of the upper endplate **114**.

(17) FIGS. 3A, 3B show a front view and a sectional view of the variable lordosis endplate **100** in the collapsed state. In the collapsed state, a top surface **154** of the upper endplate **114** and a bottom surface **120** of the body **102** are parallel to each other. The proximal end of the driver **116** includes a tool engagement feature configured to engage a driver actuation tool to rotate the driver **116**. In the collapsed state, the shuttle **110** is positioned near a distal end of the threaded portion of the

driver **100**.

(18) FIGS. **4A**, **4B** show a front view and a sectional view of the variable lordosis endplate **100** in the expanded state. To expand the variable lordosis endplate **100** from the collapsed state to expanded state, a driver actuation tool is used to rotate **R1** the driver **106** and translate **T1** the shuttle **110** from the distal end of the threaded portion of the driver **106** toward the proximal end. In the expanded state, the top surface **154** of the upper endplate **114** is angled at a lordotic angle in relation to the bottom surface **120** of the body **102**. The lordotic angle may be adjusted to any angle between 0 to 30 degrees. In other embodiments, the angle may be greater than 30 degrees.

(19) FIG. **5** shows an exploded perspective side view of a variable lordosis endplate **100** having a body **102**, column quick attachment pins **104**, a driver **106**, driver retention pins **108**, a shuttle **110**, shuttle pins **112**, an upper endplate **114**, and a hinge pin **116**.

(20) The body **102** includes an upper surface **118**, a lower surface **120**, and a central opening **122**. The upper surface **118** includes a proximal driver holder **124**, a distal driver holder **126**, and one or more hinge pin holders **128**. The proximal driver holder **124** includes a driver head opening **130** and one or more driver retention pin holes **132** configured to receive the driver retention pins **108**. The distal driver holder **126** includes a driver shaft opening **134**. The one or more hinge pin holders **128** include a hinge pin hole **136** configured to receive the hinge pin **116**. The body **102** also includes one or more column attachment pin holes **138** configured to receive the column attachment pins **104**. The column attachment pins **104** are made of a flexible wire that is configured to flex and click into grooves within a central column.

(21) The variable lordosis endplate **100** is movable between a collapsed state (shown in FIG. **1A**) to an expanded state (shown in FIG. **2A**) via proximal movement of the shuttle **110** by the driver **106**. In the embodiment shown, the driver **106** is a drive screw that includes a proximal end having a driver head **140** with a retention groove **142** and threaded shaft **144** with a distal end **146**. The driver head **140** is sized to fit within the driver head opening **130** and the retention pins **108** retain the driver to the body while preventing the driver from rotating when the plate is compressed. The flexible pins rest on flats **143** within the driver to resist rotation forces generated through the driver's thread. The retention pins **108** may be flexible nitinol wires. Other forms of driver retention may be used to the same effect such as a flexible retaining ring. The distal end **146** of the threaded shaft **144** is configured to rotatably couple with the driver shaft opening **134**.

(22) In the embodiment shown, the shuttle **110** has a generally U-shape with a proximal frame **148** and arms **150a**, **150b** extending distally from the frame **148**. The proximal frame **148** includes a threaded hole **152** configured to rotatably couple with the threaded shaft **144** of the driver **106**. The arms **150a**, **150b** include angled slots **152a**, **152b** configured to receive the shuttle pins **112**.

(23) Rotation of the driver **106** axially translates the shuttle **110** on the threads **144**. Rotation of the driver **106** in a first direction translates the shuttle **110** proximally and rotation of the driver **106** in a second direction translates the shuttle **110** distally. Simultaneously as the shuttle **110** translates, the shuttle pins **116a**, **116b** translate up or down in the angled slots **152a**, **152b** lifting or lowering the proximal portion of the upper endplate to change the lordotic angle of the variable lordosis endplate **100**.

(24) The upper endplate **114** includes an upper surface **154** and a lower surface **156**. The upper surface **154** is configured to contact a vertebra. The lower surface includes shuttle pin holders **158a**, **158b** with shuttle pin holes **160**, and one or more hinge pin holders **162a** with hinge pin holes. The upper endplate **114** may vary in shape and/or geometry for the different spinal locations and/or anatomical needs.

(25) FIGS. **6A-6C** show a front view and perspective view of a variable lordosis endplate **200** in a collapsed state and a perspective view showing the variable lordosis endplate **200** in an expanded state. The variable lordosis endplate **200** shown is designed for use in a cervical application.

(26) FIGS. **7A-7C** is a front view and perspective view showing a variable lordosis endplate **300** in a collapsed state and a perspective view showing the variable lordosis endplate **300** in an expanded

state. The variable lordosis endplate **300** shown is designed for use in a thoracic application having an upper endplate that is round and larger than the cervical upper endplate.

(27) FIGS. **8A-8C** is a front view and perspective view showing a variable lordosis endplate **400** in a collapsed state and a perspective view showing the variable lordosis endplate **400** in an expanded state. The variable lordosis endplate **400** shown is designed for use in a lumbar application having an upper endplate that is rectangular and larger than the cervical or thoracic endplate.

(28) While a driver **106** is shown, any suitable mechanism may be used that is capable of translating the shuttle **110** proximally or distally to rotate the upper endplate **114** to change the lordotic angle.

(29) The variable lordosis endplate **100** is movable between a collapsed state (shown in FIG. **1A**) to an expanded state (shown in FIG. **2A**) via movement of the shuttle **110** by the driver **106**. In the embodiment shown, the shuttle **110** is positioned near the distal end of the driver **106**. Rotation of the driver **106** in a first direction **R1** proximally translates **T1** the shuttle **110**. Simultaneously, the shuttle pins **116a**, **116b** are translated **T2** upwardly in the angled slots **152a**, **152b** to rotate the upper endplate **114** around the hinge pin **116** in a first direction **R2** to increase the lordotic angle.

(30) Rotation of the driver **106** in a second direction translates the shuttle **110** distally.

Simultaneously, the shuttle pins **116a**, **116b** are translated downwardly in the angled slots **152a**, **152b** to rotate the upper endplate **114** around the hinge pin **116** in a second direction to lower the lordotic angle.

(31) All components may be comprised of machined, anodized titanium except for the nitinol pins which consist of super elastic nitinol.

(32) The lordotic angle adjustment of the variable lordosis endplate **100** may be performed when the variable lordosis endplate **100** is coupled to the patient's spine. Thus, a surgeon can install the variable lordosis endplate **100** into the patient' spine and then rotate and rotate the driver to change the lordotic angle in-situ. Thus, prior to installation, the variable lordosis endplate **100** may be preassembled with a first lordotic angle, but once it is installed, the lordotic angle may be adjusted by the surgeon to a second lordotic angle.

(33) The improvements made by the present invention include: The variable lordosis endplate only requires inventory of varying footprints since the lordotic profile can be adjusted across a wide range (0 to 30 degrees per endplate). New flexibility is achieved in the operating room by having the option of one or two variable lordosis endplates. The endplates may be removed in the operating room to facilitate different surgical techniques if needed. The surgeon may fine-tune the implant's lordotic profile in-situ instead of having to choose between pre-set angles. Prior art systems inserted with endplates of an undesirable lordotic angle would then have to be removed have the endplates changed.

(34) While embodiments and applications of this invention have been shown and described, it would be apparent to those skilled in the art that many more modifications than mentioned above are possible without departing from the inventive concepts herein.

Claims

1. A variable lordosis endplate comprising: a body having a body upper surface; a driver coupled to the body upper surface; an upper endplate having an endplate lower surface hingedly coupled to the body upper surface; a shuttle having a first part coupled to the driver for axial translation and a second part coupled to the upper endplate lower surface for lifting translation, wherein the driver includes a threaded portion coupled to the first part of the shuttle, and rotation of the driver axially translates the shuttle; wherein the driver is configured to simultaneously translate the shuttle axially and lift the upper endplate angularly away from the body to change a lordosis angle; wherein the second part of the shuttle includes angled slots coupled to the upper endplate with a shuttle pin, during axial translation of the shuttle on the threaded portion of the driver, the shuttle pin translates

up the angled slots to lift the proximal end of the upper endplate away from the body to change the lordosis angle.

2. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 1, wherein the driver is configured to translate the shuttle from a first position with no lordosis angle to a second position with a lordosis angle.
 3. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 2, wherein in the first position the variable lordosis endplate is in a collapsed state with an upper endplate surface being parallel to a lower body surface.
 4. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 2, wherein in the second position the variable lordosis endplate is in an expanded state with a lordosis angle between the upper endplate and the lower body surface.
 5. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 2, wherein the lordosis angle is variable by stopping the translation of the shuttle anywhere between the first and second positions.
 6. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 1, wherein the lordosis angle is between 0 to 30 degrees.
 7. A variable lordosis endplate comprising: an upper endplate having an upper surface and a lower surface with upper hinge pin holders; a lower endplate having a lower surface and an upper surface with lower hinge pin holders; a hinge pin rotatably coupled to the upper and lower hinge pin holders; a driver rotatably coupled to the lower endplate; a shuttle axially coupled to the driver and angularly coupled to the upper endplate, the driver being configured to move the shuttle from a first position to a second position to change to a lordosis angle between the upper surface of the upper endplate and the lower surface of the lower endplate; wherein the shuttle includes angled slots coupled to the upper endplate with shuttle pins, during axial translation of the shuttle in a proximal direction on the threaded portion of the driver, the shuttle pins translate up the angled slots to lift the proximal end of the upper endplate away from the body to change the lordosis angle.
 8. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 7, wherein in the first position the variable lordosis endplate is in a collapsed state with the upper surface of the upper endplate being parallel to the lower surface of the lower endplate.
 9. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 7, wherein in the second position the variable lordosis endplate is in an expanded state with a lordosis angle between the upper endplate and the lower body surface.
 10. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 7, wherein movement of the shuttle driver from the first position to the second position lifts the proximal end of the upper endplate while rotating the upper endplate away from the lower end plate and changing the lordotic angle of the variable lordosis endplate.
 11. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 7, wherein in the first position there is no lordosis angle and in the second position there is a maximum lordosis angle.
 12. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 7, wherein the lordosis angle is between 0 to 30 degrees.
 13. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 7, wherein the lordosis angle is variable by stopping the translation of the shuttle anywhere between the first and second positions.
 14. The variable lordosis endplate of claim 7, wherein rotation of the driver in a distal direction translates the shuttle distally and simultaneously, the shuttle pins are translated downwardly in the angled slots to rotate the upper endplate around the hinge pin to lower the lordotic angle.
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